Roam

Install Roam yourself

The do-it-yourself way with SideStore. Follow every step in order and don't skip any. The first time takes about 30 minutes.

What you need

- An iPhone with **iOS 27 or newer**, with a **passcode**
- A **cable** from your iPhone to the computer
- **Wi-Fi**. Mobile data does not work for this
- A **Mac or Windows computer**, just once
- Your **Apple ID** and its password (a free one is fine)
- About **30 minutes** and a little patience

Prefer no computer and no refreshing? Buy a pass on roamlocation.com and use the easy way instead.

Start here

The big picture

There are 5 parts. Do them in this order. Tick each one off when it's done.

⬇️

1. Download

Get the apps on your iPhone and computer first.

🔌

2. SideStore

Use the computer once to put SideStore on your iPhone.

➕

3. Get Roam

Add Roam in SideStore and install it.

⚙️

4. Set up Roam

Free trial, pairing, VPN and location.

🗺️

5. Use it

Pick a place and tap Teleport.

What is SideStore?

An app store you put on your iPhone yourself. It installs apps that aren't in Apple's App Store, like Roam, using your own Apple ID.

What is LocalDevVPN?

A free app from the App Store. SideStore and Roam need it to talk to your iPhone. It stays inside your iPhone and doesn't send your internet anywhere.

Every 7 days a refresh

With a free Apple ID, apps last 7 days. SideStore renews them for you. More about that in Part 6.

Max 3 apps

A free Apple ID can have 3 of these apps at once. SideStore is one, Roam is the second.

The official SideStore guide is here, with the newest downloads: https://docs.sidestore.io/docs/installation/prerequisites. If something on your screen is different from this guide, follow the SideStore guide for Part 2.

Part 1 Download everything first

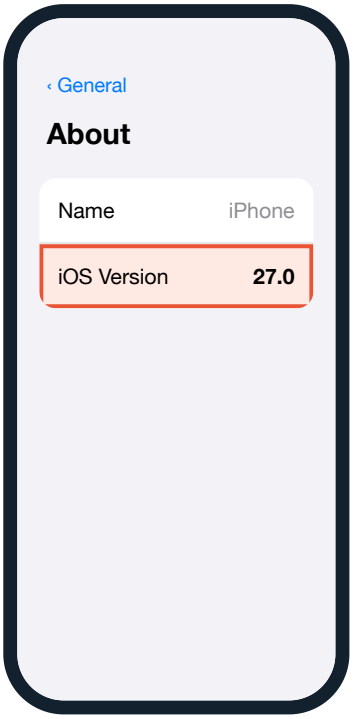
Before you start, get the apps ready. Don't plug anything in yet.

1 Check your iOS version

On your iPhone, open **Settings › General › About**. Look at **iOS Version**.

It must say **27** or higher.

Lower than 27? Stop here. Update in **Settings › General › Software Update** first. Roam does not work on older iOS.



Drawing: your screen may look a little different

2 On your iPhone: download LocalDevVPN

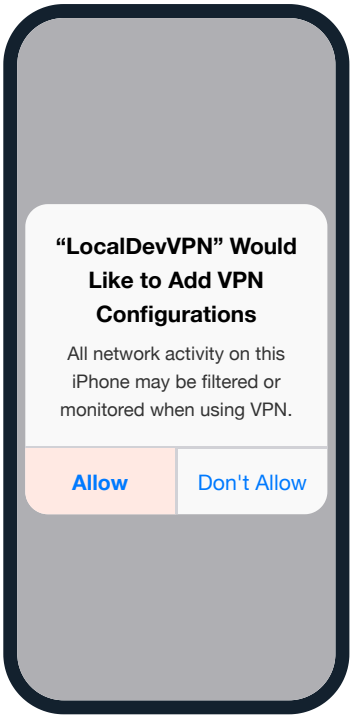
1. Open the **App Store**.
2. Search for **LocalDevVPN**.
3. Tap **Get**. It's free.

Direct link: https://apps.apple.com/app/localdevvpn/id6755608044

3 Turn on LocalDevVPN

1. Open **LocalDevVPN**.
2. Tap **Connect**.
3. iOS asks to add a VPN. Tap **Allow** and type your passcode.

Remember LocalDevVPN must be **connected** every time you install or refresh apps in SideStore, and every time you use Roam.



Drawing: your screen may look a little different

4 On your computer: download iloader

iloader is a free helper program. It puts SideStore on your iPhone.

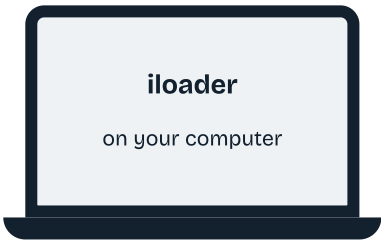
On a Mac:

1. Go to **https://iloader.app** and download the Mac version.
2. Open the downloaded file and drag **iloader** to **Applications**.

On Windows:

1. First install **iTunes**, from the Microsoft Store or from **apple.com/itunes**. iloader needs it to see your iPhone.
2. Then go to **https://iloader.app** and download the Windows version (the **MSI** one). Install it.

Not supported: 32-bit Windows and Windows on Arm.



Drawing

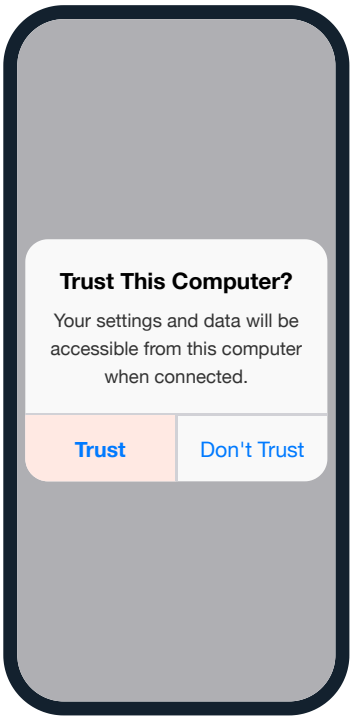
Part 2

Put SideStore on your iPhone

You need the computer only for this part, and only once. Stuck? See the **official SideStore guide**.

5 Plug in your iPhone

1. Connect your iPhone to the computer with the cable.
2. Unlock your iPhone.
3. Your iPhone asks **Trust This Computer?** Tap **Trust** and type your passcode.



Drawing: your screen may look a little different

6 Open iloader and sign in

1. Open **iloader** on the computer.
2. Sign in with your **Apple ID** and password.
3. If Apple sends you a code, type it in.

Careful Type your Apple ID exactly right: capital letters matter. Your password only goes to Apple, to sign the app.

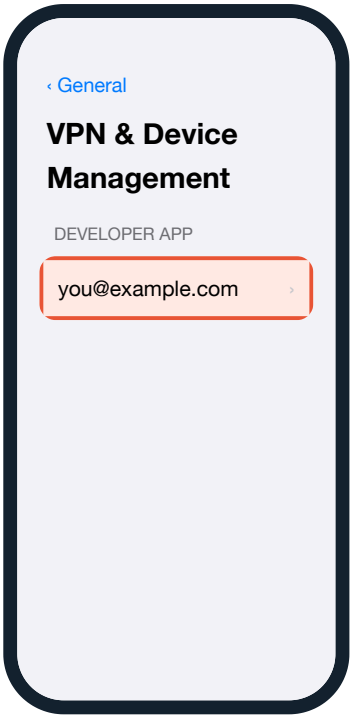
7 Install SideStore

1. In iloader, click your **iPhone**.
2. Click **Install SideStore (Stable)**.
3. Wait until iloader says it's done. Don't unplug the cable while it works.

SideStore now appears on your iPhone's Home Screen. It won't open yet. That's normal: do the next steps first.

8 Trust your Apple ID on the iPhone

1. On your iPhone, open **Settings › General › VPN & Device Management**.
2. Under **Developer App**, tap your Apple ID e-mail.
3. Tap **Trust**, then **Allow & Restart**.
4. Type your passcode.

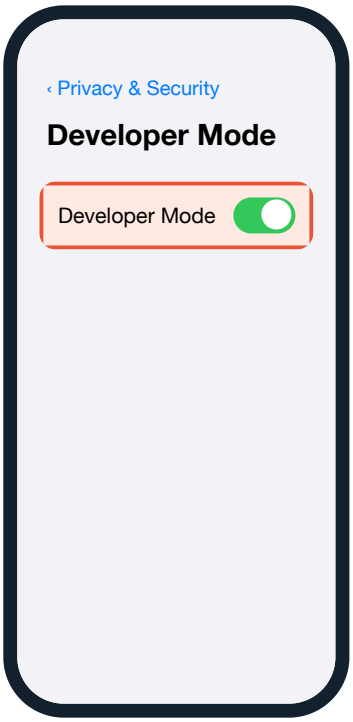


Drawing: your screen may look a little different

9 Turn on Developer Mode

1. Open **Settings › Privacy & Security**.
2. Scroll **all the way down**.
3. Tap **Developer Mode** and turn it **on**.
4. Tap **Restart**. After the restart, tap **Turn On** and type your passcode.

Can't find Developer Mode? It only shows up after step 7. Make sure SideStore is on your Home Screen.



Drawing: your screen may look a little different

10 Open SideStore for the first time

1. Open **LocalDevVPN** and tap **Connect**.
2. Open **SideStore**.
3. Sign in with the **same Apple ID** you used in iloader.

11

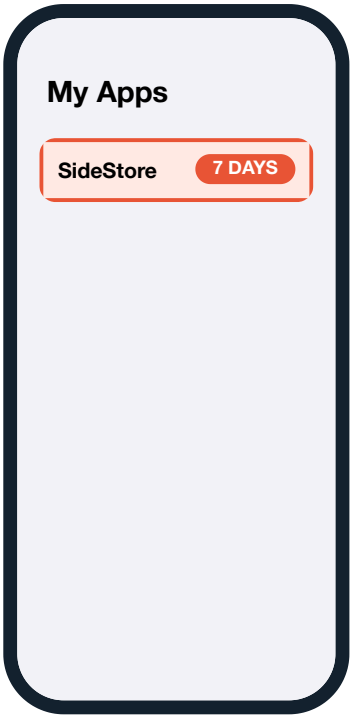
Refresh SideStore once

1. In SideStore, tap **My Apps** at the bottom.
2. Next to SideStore you see a button like **7 DAYS**. Tap it.
3. If it asks about a certificate, tap **Yes** or **Refresh Now**.

Your iPhone jumps to the Home Screen and shows a notification. **That's good.** Open SideStore again after a few seconds.

Do this before you add Roam. SideStore's own guide says to refresh SideStore first, or apps can disappear later.

You can unplug the cable now.



Drawing, not the real SideStore screen

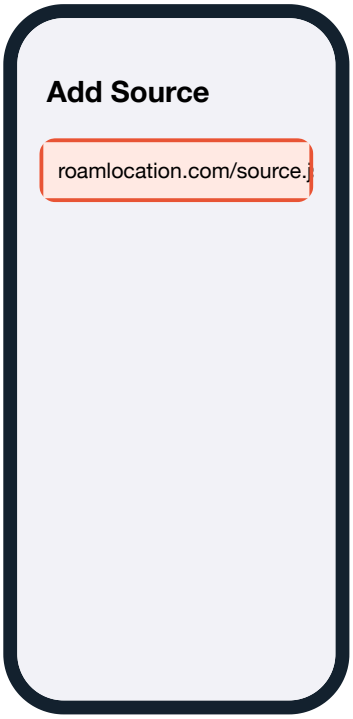
Part 3

Get Roam

Now the easy part.

12 Add the Roam source

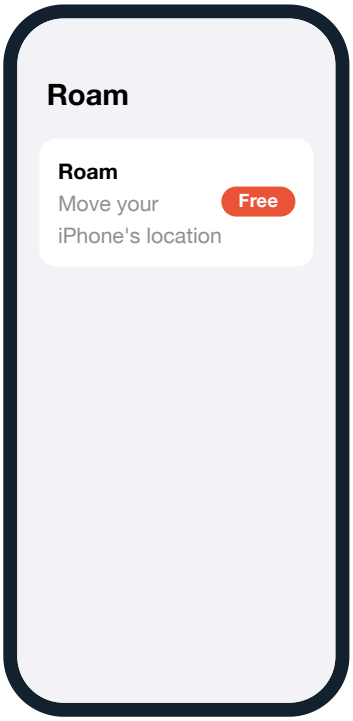
1. Make sure **LocalDevVPN** is connected.
2. In SideStore, tap **Sources** at the bottom.
3. Tap **+** (top corner).
4. Type or paste: **roamlocation.com/source.json**
5. Tap **Add**.



Drawing, not the real SideStore screen

13 Install Roam

1. In the source, tap **Roam**.
2. Tap **Free** (or **Get**).
3. Wait until it's done. Roam appears on your Home Screen.



Drawing, not the real SideStore screen

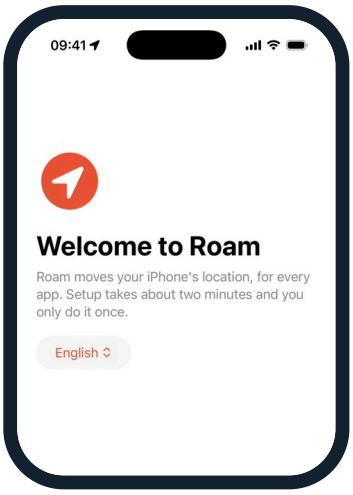
Part 4

Set up Roam

Open Roam. It walks you through a few short screens. You only do this once.

14 Welcome

Pick your language if you want, then tap **Get started**.



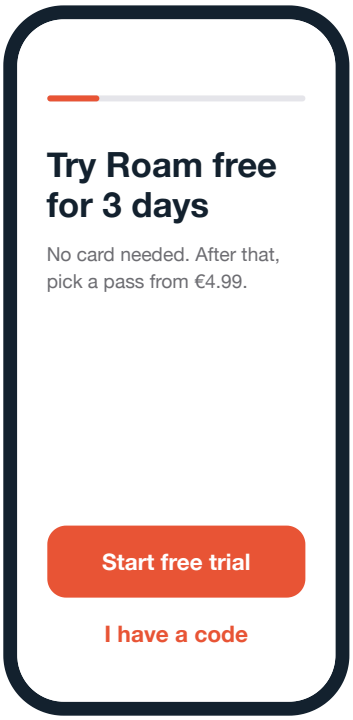
First screen in Roam

15 Start your free trial

Roam says **Try Roam free for 3 days**. No card needed.

Tap **Start free trial**. That's it, you don't need a code from anyone.

Already bought a pass? Tap **I have a code**, type it and tap **Activate**.



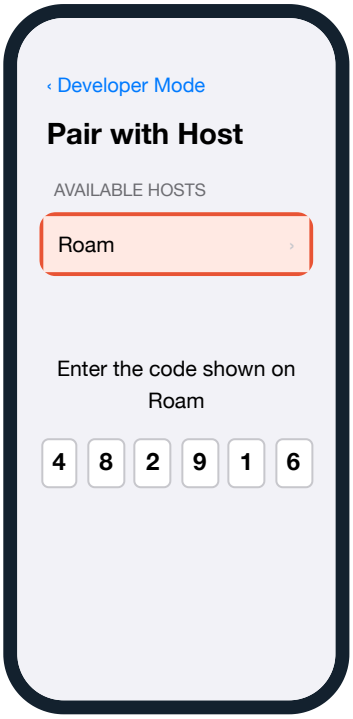
Drawing of the trial screen

16 Connect Roam to your iPhone

Roam needs a one-time “handshake” with your iPhone. Like pairing headphones.

1. In Roam, tap **Start pairing**. Allow **Local Network** if asked.
2. Go to **Settings › Privacy & Security › Developer Mode** and tap **Pair with Host**.
3. Tap **Roam** and type your iPhone passcode.
4. Roam shows a **6-number code** (also in your notifications). Type it in Settings.

Done when Roam says **Paired**. You never have to do this again.



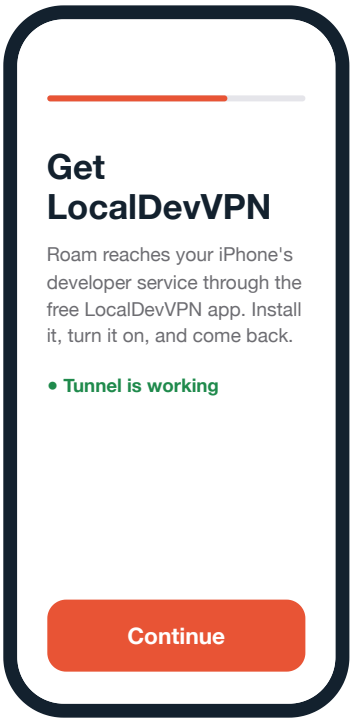
Drawing: your screen may look a little different

17 Turn on LocalDevVPN

Roam talks to your iPhone through the free **LocalDevVPN** app, the same one SideStore uses.

Tap **Turn on LocalDevVPN**. In LocalDevVPN tap **Connect**, then come back to Roam.

Done when Roam says **Tunnel is working**. Tap Continue.

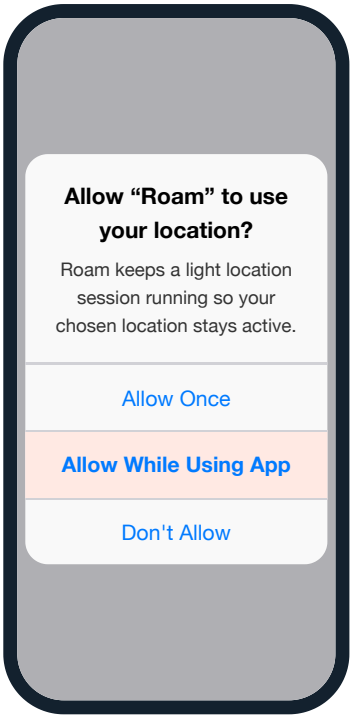


Drawing of the VPN screen

18 Allow location

Tap **Allow location**, then choose **Allow While Using App**.

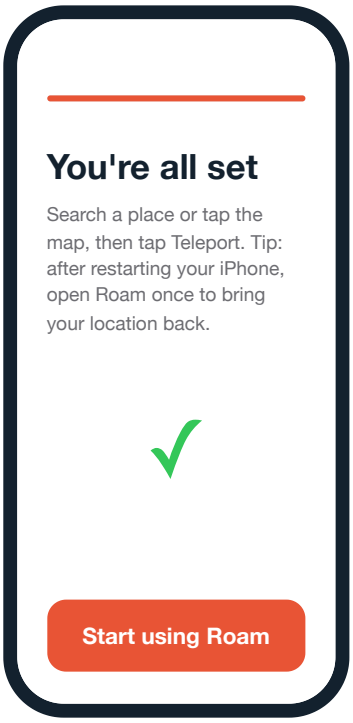
Roam needs this to keep your new place switched on while you use other apps.



Drawing: your screen may look a little different

19 All set!

Tap **Start using Roam**. That's it, the hard part is over.



Drawing of the last setup screen

Part 5

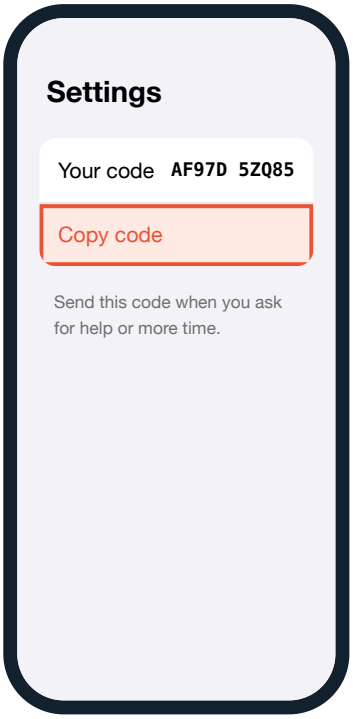
Your code, and buying a pass

Find your code

Roam gives you your own code when you start the trial. You find it here:

1. In Roam, tap the ⚙ **gear** top left.
2. Scroll down to **Your code**.
3. Tap **Copy code**.

Send this code when you ask for help or more time. With it we can find you.



Drawing of Roam's Settings

When the trial ends

1. Your location goes back to normal and Roam shows the passes: a day, a week, a month or a year.
2. Tap the pass you want. Safari opens. Pay there.
3. We switch your pass on within 1 hour.
4. Back in Roam, tap **I paid, check again**. Or just open Roam later: it checks by itself.

Money back If Roam doesn't work on your iPhone within 7 days, you get your money back.

Questions, ideas or bugs? Join the Roam Discord: https://discord.gg/swvFYgDdf. Paste your code there if you need help.

Part 6

Every 7 days

This is the one thing to remember with this way.

Let SideStore refresh

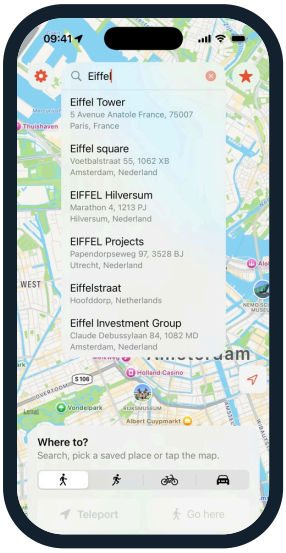
Keep **LocalDevVPN** connected and be on **Wi-Fi**. SideStore renews Roam in the background.

To do it yourself: open SideStore › **My Apps** and tap the **DAYS** button next to Roam.

Roam won't open? It wasn't refreshed in time. Connect LocalDevVPN, open SideStore, go to My Apps and tap the DAYS button. Your places and your code are still there.

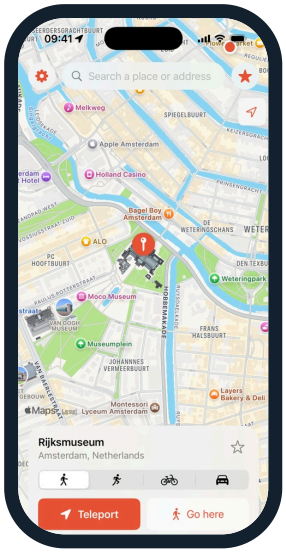
Part 7 Using Roam

The fun part. You'll get the hang of it in a minute.



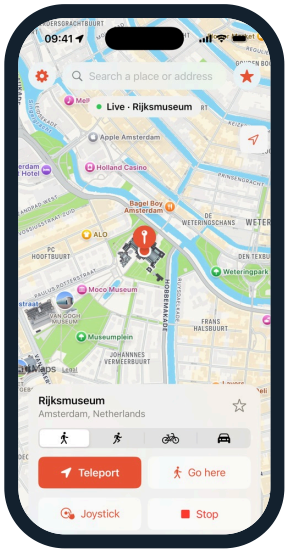
1. Find a place

Type a city, street or address in the search bar at the top. Or press and hold anywhere on the map.



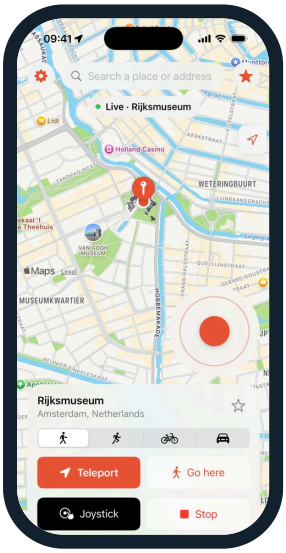
2. Tap Teleport

Your iPhone is there right away. Open Find My or Maps to see it.



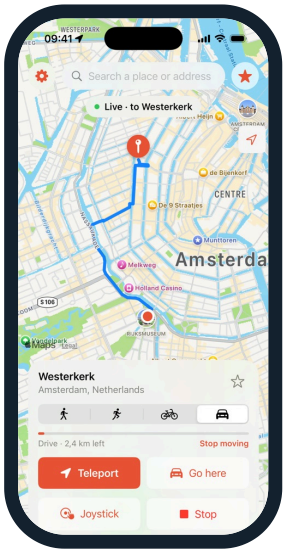
3. Stop when done

"Live" at the top means it's on. Tap **Stop** to go back to your real location.



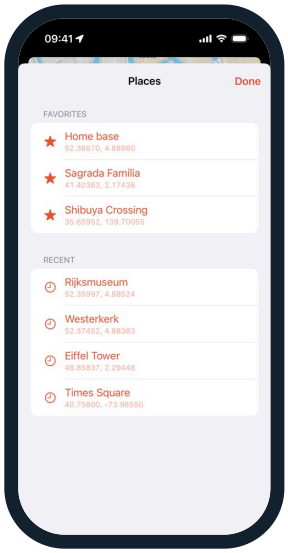
Walk around

Tap **Joystick** and drag the circle to walk. Pick walk, run, bike or car for the speed.



Follow a route

Pick a place and tap **Go here**. Roam moves along real roads, at the speed you chose.



Save your favourites

Tap the ☆ on a place to save it. The ★ button top right shows your saved and recent places.

Tip After you restart your iPhone, open Roam once. It brings your chosen place back by itself.

Good to know

How Roam works

You don't need to understand this to use Roam. But it's nice to know what happens.

📍

Your iPhone knows where it is

Normally it uses GPS, Wi-Fi and cell towers.

🛠️

Apple built a test switch

App makers use it to test their apps in other places. It's called Developer Mode.

🗺️

Roam uses that switch

You pick a place, Roam tells your iPhone: “pretend you're here.”

📱

Every app follows

Maps, Find My, Weather and the rest all see the new place.

Is this a hack or a jailbreak?

No. Roam uses the same tool from Apple that app makers use (Xcode). Your iPhone stays normal and safe.

What is the small VPN for?

Roam talks to your own iPhone through it. It stays inside your iPhone. Your internet doesn't go through it.

Can apps see it's not real?

iOS marks the location as “simulated”. Most apps don't look, but some can. Games and some apps forbid it, so don't use Roam there.

Does my location go to you?

No. Your places stay on your iPhone. Roam doesn't track you.

Help

If something goes wrong

iloader doesn't see my iPhone

Unlock the iPhone and tap Trust. Try another cable or USB port. On Windows: install iTunes first.

SideStore says it can't connect

Open LocalDevVPN and tap Connect. Be on Wi-Fi. Then try again.

“Untrusted Developer”

Do step 8 again: **Settings › General › VPN & Device Management**, tap your Apple ID, Trust.

I can't find Developer Mode

SideStore must be on your iPhone first (step 7). Then look at the very bottom of Privacy & Security.

SideStore stopped working after an iOS update

Its pairing file expired. Plug in, open iloader, click **Delete Stored Pairing**, Trust on the iPhone, then **Manage Pairing File › Place** next to SideStore.

SideStore login fails

Often Apple's sign-in helper is down for a while. Wait an hour and try again.

Pairing in Roam doesn't work

Allow Local Network for Roam in **Settings › Roam**, keep Wi-Fi on and tap Start pairing again.

My location jumped back

Open Roam. It reconnects by itself. After restarting your iPhone, open Roam once.

Still stuck? Roam questions: https://discord.gg/swvFYgDdf (send your code). SideStore or iloader problems: the official guide at https://docs.sidestore.io/docs/installation/prerequisites.